

Victor David Bernal Pavas

Houston, TX

vdbernalpavas@uh.edu | www.victordavidbernal.com | +1 (281) 745-2798

Education

University of Houston , Houston, TX Ph.D. in Economics, expected 2027	August 2022–Present
Universidad EAFIT , Medellín, Colombia M.Sc. in Economics, <i>with honors</i>	2019–2020
Universidad de Antioquia , Medellín, Colombia Bachelor's Degree in Economics, <i>with honors</i>	2012–2017

Research Interests

Urban Economics, Transportation Economics, Public Economics, Environmental Economics, Applied Microeconomics.

Publications

Bernal, D., García, G. A., and Pérez Pérez, J. “[Better or Worse Job Accessibility? Understanding Changes in Spatial Mismatch: Evidence from Medellín, Colombia.](#)” *Journal of Transport Geography*, 128, 104341, 2025.

Working Papers

[Less Traffic, Higher Tolls: Optimal Congestion Pricing under Remote Work and Traveler Heterogeneity](#)

Job Market Paper

[From Conflict to Human Capital? Evidence from Colombia's Peace Process](#)

Working Paper

The Effect of Policy Variation on Urban Density: The Consequences of Crossed Borders for Cities

With Steven Craig, Edward Hoang, and Steven Bond-Smith.

Teaching Experience

University of Houston , Houston, TX <i>Instructor</i>	August 2022–Present
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- Principles of Microeconomics

Teaching Assistant

- Ph.D. Urban Economics
- Introduction to Econometrics
- Social Economy and Enterprise Academy Internship Program
- History of Economic Doctrine
- Intermediate Microeconomics

Research and Professional Experience

Consultant, Inter-American Development Bank – Project Effectiveness Evaluation at IDB Invest December 2021–August 2022

Research Assistant, Johns Hopkins University July 2021–July 2022

- Research assistant for Professor Luis Quintero.

Research Assistant, Harvard Business School January 2021–February 2022

- Research assistant for Professor Jorge Tamayo.

External Consultant, Banco de México October 2020–April 2021

- Research assistant for Jorge Pérez.

Research Assistant, Universidad EAFIT January 2019–July 2020

- Research assistant for Professor Gustavo García.

Presentations and Summer Schools

- “Less Traffic, Higher Tolls: Optimal Congestion Pricing under Remote Work and Traveler Heterogeneity.” North American Regional Science Council (NARSC), Philadelphia, November 11–14, 2026. *Expected presentation.*
- Participant, Price Theory Summer Camp, University of Chicago, June 2025.
- “Better or Worse Job Accessibility? Understanding Changes in Spatial Mismatch at the Intra-urban Level in Medellín.” Latin American Economic Association (LACEA), November 2023.
- “Better or Worse Job Accessibility? Understanding Changes in Spatial Mismatch at the Intra-urban Level in Medellín.” European Regional Science Association (ERSA), online conference “Spatial Challenges for the New World,” August 26, 2020.

Awards and Honors

- Master’s thesis received academic distinction from Universidad EAFIT.
- Bachelor’s thesis received academic distinction from Universidad de Antioquia.
- Media coverage of undergraduate thesis: [El Colombiano](#); [UDEA](#); [El Tiempo](#).
- The undergraduate thesis formed the basis of a successful legal challenge to Colombia’s gasoline surcharge tax. In 2019, the Constitutional Court ruled the taxable base unconstitutional following a lawsuit filed by the thesis authors based on the study’s findings.

Skills

Software: Stata, R, ArcGIS, Python, EViews, MATLAB, Dynare, $\text{\LaTeX}$, Microsoft Office.

Languages: Spanish, native; English, fluent; French, intermediate.

References

Vikram Maheshri
Professor
University of Houston
Houston, TX
vmaheshri@uh.edu

Janet E. Kohlase
Professor
University of Houston
Houston, TX
jkohlase@uh.edu

Fan Wang
Associate Professor
University of Houston
Houston, TX
fwang26@uh.edu